RESCUELOGIC®

A Minimal Event Information Model

Review Version

Revision 0.2 • Companion to proposed SAFER Protocol v1.1

The SAFER Protocol and the Grammar of a Reported Event

$$e_t = (\text{System}, \text{Identity}, \text{DeviceType}, \text{Location}, \text{Condition}_t)$$

CORE EVENT SENTENCE This system reports that this device, of this type, at this location, has changed to this state.

Dan Horon
Cadgraphics Incorporated / RescueLogic
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For technical review and discussion. This review version condenses the full working paper and focuses on the event model, boundary, and review questions.

Contents at a glance

1	1. Executive Summary
2	2. The Core Event Model
3	3. State Changes and Reported Observations
4	4. Why Device Type Matters
5	5. Observation, Classification, Integrity, and Response
6	6. SAFER Representation
7	7. The Interoperability Boundary
8	8. Legacy Reporting and Modern Context
9	9. Relationship to Existing IoT / Industrial Models
10	10. What SAFER Defines / What It Does Not Define
11	11. Review Questions and Next Development
A	Appendix A — What Is an Alarm Event?
B	Appendix B — Fire Alarm Panels Speak the Same Language
C	Appendix C — References

1. Executive Summary

Life-safety systems contain a large amount of manufacturer-specific information, but the information needed to describe a reported point event is smaller and more stable than the surrounding systems make it appear.

SAFER addresses that stable center. It makes explicit the recurring roles already used in point lists, floor plans, panel messages, event histories, and monitoring displays: the reporting system, point identity, device type, location, and reported condition.

$$e_t = (\text{System}, \text{Identity}, \text{DeviceType}, \text{Location}, \text{Condition}_t)$$

ONE-PARAGRAPH MODEL A reported life-safety event can be treated as a structured statement: a known system reports that a known point, of a known type, at a known location, has changed to a reported condition. Identity, Device Type, and Location describe the relatively stable object in the building; Condition is the time-varying property observed during operation; System supplies the source context.

The change-of-state sentence illustrates the conceptual event model. A transmitted report may describe a new condition, a restoration, a continuing condition, or a status observation. Receiving a report does not, by itself, establish that a new physical transition occurred.

SAFER defines	SAFER does not define
A minimal event information model	NFPA 72 compliance or response requirements
A field vocabulary for core event meaning	Product listing, equipment certification, or AHJ approval
A normalized STATUS value for machine use	Transport security, pathway supervision, or communication reliability
A way to preserve source meaning across systems	A replacement for manufacturer details, source records, or site procedures

2. The Core Event Model

The model can be expressed without mathematical notation. In plain language, every reported event has a sentence underneath it:

PRIMITIVE EVENT STATEMENT This system reports that this device, of this type, at this location, has changed to this state.

$$e_t = (\text{System}, \text{Identity}, \text{DeviceType}, \text{Location}, \text{Condition}_t) \quad (1)$$

Role	SAFER field	Plain-language question
System	PANEL_ID	Who is reporting?
Identity	DEVICE_ID	Which point?
Device Type	DEVICE_TYPE	What kind?
Location	DEVICE_LOCATION	Where?
Reported condition	STATUS (v1.1 reporting code)	What is being reported?

The conceptual reported condition is broader than numeric SAFER STATUS. STATUS communicates the defined reporting meaning. The optional CONDITION field can add a more specific human-readable description of what the source reported.

Example: Panel 01 reports that smoke detector L1S067 in Classroom 4 West has changed to ACTIVATED.

$$(\text{Panel 01}, \text{L1S067}, \text{Smoke Detector}, \text{Classroom 4 West}, \text{ACTIVATED}) \quad (2)$$

EVENT GRAMMAR The values change. The grammatical roles remain.

3. State Changes and Reported Observations

A change in a known point's condition is one kind of event. A report may describe that change, a restoration, a continuing condition, or a status observation; receipt alone does not establish a new physical transition. Point identity belongs to its reporting-system context; type and location describe the point.

An event is not the device. A report may tell us about a new transition or provide an observation of a continuing condition. The point retains its identity within its reporting-system context, while Device Type and Location describe the point and its intended place. The changing element is the Condition.

STABLE OBJECT / CONFIGURATION CONTEXT
O = (Identity, DeviceType, Location)

→

CHANGING CONDITION / OPERATIONAL STATE
C(t)

$$\text{EVENT} = \Delta\text{STATE} \times \text{DEVICE} \times \text{TIME}$$

What stays the same	What changes
Identity — which exact device or point is involved	Normal — reported or established as normal; not inferred from silence
Device Type — what kind of device or point it is	Trouble — investigate possible impairment or uncertainty
Location — where the point belongs in the building	Active — act according to applicable procedure

The event expression above is conceptual, not arithmetic. The three display categories are simplified human-facing terms, not SAFER's six STATUS values or RescueLogic's separate Logical States.

This distinction separates operational change from configuration or documentation change. A detector may report NORMAL → ACTIVATED → NORMAL while remaining the same detector in the same room. Moving the detector, changing its programmed identity, or correcting its documented type changes the description of the object, not merely its operating condition.

4. Why Device Type Matters

The same reported condition can mean different things when it belongs to different objects. A dry contact operation from a manual pull station and a dry contact operation from a sprinkler control-valve switch may both look like an active electrical change, but they do not carry the same application meaning.

Object	Observed condition	Typical interpretation
Manual pull station	ACTIVATED	Fire-alarm interpretation
Valve supervisory switch	ACTIVATED	Supervisory interpretation
Monitoring path / circuit	TROUBLE	Integrity or reliability concern

Object + Condition → Classification

The condition does not carry all of the meaning. Device Type tells what kind of object is reporting, and system configuration supplies the context needed to classify the event. That is why SAFER keeps DEVICE_TYPE and STATUS separate.

5. Observation, Classification, Integrity, and Response

A source observation, event classification, integrity question, and human response are related, but they are not the same fact. Keeping them separate allows source facts to remain reviewable while applications add interpretation.

Layer	Question	Role
Observation	What did the source report?	Preserve the source event and its point condition.
Classification	How is the event being handled?	Derive alarm, supervisory, trouble, or other category from event, configuration, and context.
Integrity	Can the system still be relied upon to tell us?	Distinguish an object's condition from confidence in the monitoring path.
Response	What should be done?	Apply site plan, policy, operator instruction, or responder procedure.

OBSERVATION ≠ CLASSIFICATION ≠ RESPONSE ACTIVATED describes the reported point condition. A classification such as FIRE ALARM or SUPERVISORY describes how that observation is interpreted. The response is a separate application decision.

YES, NO, and MAYBE

Many practical questions need a truth-preserving answer rather than another detailed classification. MAYBE protects the accuracy of both YES or NO by refusing to turn uncertainty into false certainty.

Answer	Meaning
YES	The available information supports the proposition.
NO	The available information contradicts the proposition.
MAYBE	The available information does not justify either YES or NO.

$$A(q, e_t, \text{context}) \in \{\text{YES}, \text{NO}, \text{MAYBE}\} \quad (3)$$

Question	Answer
Do the two records agree about DEVICE_TYPE?	NO
Is the Smoke Detector record proven correct by the available evidence?	MAYBE
Is the Pull Station record proven correct by the available evidence?	MAYBE

The available evidence proves disagreement, but it does not yet prove which record is correct. YES, NO, and MAYBE are derived application answers, not required SAFER v1.1 fields or additional STATUS codes.

6. SAFER Representation

The information model and the communications format are separate. The model defines the relationships. JSON is one way to carry them.

The following example is a complete baseline SAFER v1.1 payload. Its illustrative values show how the defined fields can carry a reported event.

SAFER STATUS combines dimensions of reporting: active condition, supervisory or trouble classification, restoration, status-only purpose, and previously reported history. These meanings can overlap in reality. Separating reported condition and event qualifier is a question for future development, not an adopted v1.1 change.

```
{
  "CUSTOMER": "DemoSite",
  "PANEL_ID": "PANEL 01",
  "DEVICE_ID": "L1S067",
  "DEVICE_TYPE": "SMOKE DETECTOR",
  "DEVICE_LOCATION": "CLASSROOM 4 WEST",
  "STATUS": 1,
  "SAFER_ID": {
    "version": "1.1",
    "unique_id": "123e4567-e89b-42d3-a456-426614174000"
  }
}
```

MODEL BEFORE SERIALIZATION The information model defines the event meaning. JSON carries it.

Numeric STATUS

Code	SAFER meaning
1	Active
2	Supervisory
3	Restore
4	Trouble
5	Status only
6	Previously reported

A simple state with a descriptive condition

SAFER's required numeric STATUS provides a defined reporting meaning. Optional CONDITION can preserve more specific information without changing that code. For example, two Trouble reports can both use STATUS=4 while describing Open Circuit and Ground Fault, respectively.

RescueLogic demonstrates one receiving-application approach. Its three Base States—Normal, Alarm, and Trouble—support recognizable device-state images. Separately, descriptive Condition text can help people understand the source report, including a symptom or clue about a trouble.

These Base States are not numerically equivalent to SAFER STATUS. Restore, Status only, and Previously reported may require source context or event history before a receiving application can select a displayed state.

Status-only and previously reported messages are generally informational rather than instructions for immediate action. If a site expects recurring reports, a receiving application can check whether they arrive on schedule. A missing expected report may justify investigating reporting continuity, but does not establish a point fault or a Normal condition. Expected intervals and responses belong to site or receiving-application rules, not to SAFER STATUS itself.

A small number of recognizable state categories can support a much larger variety of descriptive conditions. SAFER does not require recipients to adopt RescueLogic's state model, images, or interface design.

STATUS is a stable machine value in the serialized SAFER vocabulary. An HMI can display ACTIVE, a localized label, or another presentation without changing the transmitted value.

Uppercase field names

SAFER uses uppercase field names deliberately: PANEL_ID, DEVICE_ID, DEVICE_TYPE, DEVICE_LOCATION, and STATUS. The convention echoes alarm-panel displays, point identifiers, equipment labels, and engineering drawing notation while making the defined life-safety vocabulary visually distinct from ordinary application data.

NAMING LAYER The information model defines what a field means. The SAFER vocabulary defines what that role is called. Uppercase helps people and software recognize it when they see it.

7. The Interoperability Boundary

A fire alarm system is not a single information environment. The same physical point may appear as a programmed point, database row, floor-plan symbol, active event, event-history line, transmitted message, and responder-facing instruction.

SYNTACTIC QUESTION
Can one computer send and parse the data?

→

SEMANTIC QUESTION
Will the receiving system understand what the data means?

Two systems can successfully exchange bytes while disagreeing about the meaning of those bytes. SAFER addresses the semantic boundary: the smallest useful structure that communicates the basic meaning of a reported event.

$$e_t = (\text{System}, \text{Identity}, \text{DeviceType}, \text{Location}, \text{Condition}_t)$$

COMMON BOUNDARY The objective is to provide a shared semantic point of contact, not to force each participating system to conform internally.

The source system remains authoritative for its native detail. SAFER gives applications and people a common description of the reported event at the handoff boundary.

8. Legacy Reporting and Modern Context

Contact ID carries distinct qualifier values: Q=1 (new event/opening), Q=3 (restore/closing), and Q=6 (previously reported condition still present). The qualifier is different from an event code, partition-zone/user identifier, and SAFER STATUS. Preserve reported source data and distinguish looked-up or derived context. A finite legacy event-code list should not constrain future sensor/device types.

Compact signaling methods had a practical reason: a short code could efficiently report an event over a constrained channel. The tradeoff is that some human meaning may reside outside the transmitted message.

Compact reference	Structured SAFER event
Reference to meaning; remaining context may require a lookup table or external record.	More of the event meaning travels with the message: source, point identity, device type, location, and status.
Identifier capacity can increase without defining what each identifier means.	Defined roles make it clearer which field carries which kind of meaning.
Modern IP or cellular transport may carry the same older event representation.	SAFER addresses the information layer, not merely the transport layer.

Contact ID and other compact formats solved important interoperability problems in their design environments. SAFER does not treat those formats as failures. It addresses a different layer: the shared meaning carried between modern systems.

MODERN TRANSPORT ≠ MODERN INFORMATION MODEL Changing the communications path does not automatically change the event representation. SAFER provides a common structure for the facts the panel or source system may already know.

9. Relationship to Existing IoT / Industrial Models

Broader IoT and industrial architectures can define devices, bindings, services, security, and transports. SAFER supplies the life-safety event meaning that can be contained, mapped, or transported by those systems.

Technology	Compact relationship to SAFER
W3C Web of Things	WoT can describe a Thing and its interface; SAFER can supply the life-safety event content.
oneM2M	SAFER roles can map into oneM2M semantic and interworking mechanisms.
OPC UA	SAFER can inform a life-safety EventType or companion model within a broader industrial information model.
OGC SensorThings	SAFER can be associated with a Thing, location, sensing point, or observation where geospatial context is useful.
MQTT	MQTT can carry a serialized SAFER message; SAFER supplies the payload meaning.
Sparkplug	Sparkplug can provide topic, payload, and session conventions; SAFER contributes event semantics.

SUMMARY SAFER provides domain meaning. Other technologies may contain it, map it, or carry it.

10. What SAFER Defines / What It Does Not Define

A narrow boundary makes the proposal stronger. SAFER defines the event information layer and leaves compliance, response, equipment, pathways, listings, and transport security to the standards, authorities, products, and procedures that already govern those subjects.

SAFER defines	Explanation
Event information model	The five semantic roles needed to communicate basic event meaning.
Field vocabulary	Seven required fields: CUSTOMER, PANEL_ID, DEVICE_ID, DEVICE_TYPE, DEVICE_LOCATION, STATUS, and SAFER_ID. Optional structures can carry source information and descriptive context.
Machine-readable status representation	A stable STATUS value that receiving software can test directly.
Source-preserving structure	A way to carry source meaning without forcing internal manufacturer architectures to become the same.

SAFER does not define	Boundary
NFPA 72 compliance	Project requirements remain governed by the adopted edition, AHJ, and applicable code/standard requirements.
Product listing or equipment certification	Listing and certification remain the responsibility of applicable product standards and authorities.
Transport security or pathway supervision	Communications reliability, cybersecurity, and supervision remain governed by the chosen transport and applicable requirements.
Response policy	Operator and responder actions remain site-specific and authority-governed.
Internal manufacturer architecture	Source systems can keep loops, nodes, cards, circuits, modules, sensors, logical points, and proprietary details.

11. Review Questions and Next Development

The review version is intended to focus discussion on the model rather than on product implementation. The following questions identify the work needed to test, refine, and standardize the event layer.

DISCUSSION — What should STATUS mean next? One approach retains the six compact codes for compatibility and simplicity. Another separates reported condition/classification from event qualifier for greater precision. SAFER v1.1 retains its six codes. Readers can share real source messages, expected interpretations, and information lost or preserved through GitHub Issues. Specific proposals, test cases, and migration considerations can be discussed before changes are considered for a future version.

Review question	Why it matters
Are the five roles sufficient?	The model should be small enough to use broadly but complete enough to preserve basic event meaning.
How should STATUS be versioned?	Receiving systems need stable values while future extensions remain possible.
How should source messages be preserved?	Original manufacturer messages and native details may be important for audit, troubleshooting, and validation.
How should mappings be validated?	A mapping should preserve source meaning and expose disagreements instead of hiding them.
How should uncertainty be represented?	YES / NO / MAYBE answers need validation rules for incomplete, conflicting, stale, or newly restored information.
How should SAFER fit existing standards work?	A standards crosswalk can ask focused questions without reproducing copyrighted code text or redefining established fire-alarm terms.
How should broad state classifications and descriptive CONDITION work together?	A compact state vocabulary can remain recognizable while preserving specific condition detail useful to different applications and people.

WORKING CONCLUSION SAFER makes explicit a structure the fire-alarm industry already uses implicitly every day. Different systems do not have to work the same way to share the same basic information. Meaning can remain stable while transport, serialization, presentation, and application logic evolve.

Appendix A — What Is an Alarm Event?

A change in a known point's condition is one type of event. The point remains identifiable while its condition changes. A transmitted report may also describe a restoration, continuing condition, or status observation. Identity belongs to the point within its source context; TYPE and LOCATION describe it.

CORE SENTENCE This system reports that this device, of this type, at this location, has changed to this state.

$$\text{DEVICE} = (\text{ID}, \text{TYPE}, \text{LOCATION})$$
$$\text{STATE} = \text{Normal} \mid \text{Trouble} \mid \text{Active}$$
$$\text{EVENT} = \Delta\text{STATE} \times \text{DEVICE} \times \text{TIME}$$

Device	State	Meaning
Smoke Detector, Classroom 4 West	Normal	Normal condition reported or otherwise established; silence alone is not proof.
Smoke Detector, Classroom 4 West	Trouble	Investigate; operation may be impaired.
Smoke Detector, Classroom 4 West	Active	Act according to the applicable procedure.

TAKEAWAY ID, TYPE, and LOCATION describe the known point. Its condition changes; the report may describe a change, restoration, or repetition. The three categories are a simplified human-facing model, not the SAFER STATUS enumeration.

Appendix B — Fire Alarm Panels Speak the Same Language

Different manufacturers report familiar information roles in different layouts. Some values are explicit; others require site records or reporting-source context. SAFER supplies common roles without requiring identical manufacturer messages. The examples below illustrate possible interpretations, not literal SAFER field values or validated SAFER payloads.

Example display fragment	Illustrative SAFER interpretation
N01-L1:001 ALARM ON PHOTO / CONFERENCE ROOM	STATUS = 1; DEVICE_ID = N01-L1:001; DEVICE_TYPE = PHOTO; LOCATION = CONFERENCE ROOM
ALARM: WATERFLOW / 1M001 / CONFERENCE ROOM	STATUS = 1; DEVICE_ID = 1M001; DEVICE_TYPE = WATERFLOW; LOCATION = CONFERENCE ROOM
FIRE ALARM / PULL STATION / CONFERENCE ROOM / M1-1	STATUS = 1; DEVICE_TYPE = PULL STATION; LOCATION = CONFERENCE ROOM; DEVICE_ID = M1-1
XML event with state, ptname, ptid, pttype	Source state may require translation to SAFER STATUS; DEVICE_LOCATION ← ptname; DEVICE_ID ← ptid; DEVICE_TYPE ← pttype

The source fragments illustrate recognizable or interpreted information roles; they are not validated SAFER messages. Source documentation, site configuration, or translation rules may be needed before assigning numeric SAFER STATUS or another defined SAFER field.

MIRROR EFFECT A panel message, printer line, database record, floor-plan symbol, or SAFER JSON report can reflect information about the same known point and its reported condition. Not every report proves a new physical transition.

The formatting varies, but recurring information roles can be recognized. Accurate translation may require source context and reliable configuration data; conversion is not necessarily lossless.

Modern Manufacturer Examples

The ten excerpts below retain the recognizable manufacturer examples. They illustrate recurring roles for ID, TYPE, LOCATION rather than one-to-one translations. Broad NORMAL, ACTIVE, or TROUBLE display categories may coexist with more detailed source condition text.

Manufacturer	Illustrative source message or fragment
KiddeFenwal	12:00:00 04/14/25 N01-L1:001 ALARM ON PHOTO CONFERENCE ROOM
NOTIFIER® by Honeywell	ALARM: WATERFLOW CONFERENCE ROOM Z000 12:00A 041425 1M001
Gamewell FCI by Honeywell	FIRST ALARM CONFERENCE ROOM Waterflow Sil L1M002 12:00:00 04/14/25
Fike	N01 1-001 PHOTOELECTRIC SMOKE CONFERENCE ROOM ALARM 04/14/25 17:27:46
SIEMENS	ALARM IN 1-1 12:00:00 Apr 14, 2025 SD CONFERENCE ROOM FDO421
Simplex	FIRE EVACUATE PULL STATION CONFERENCE ROOM M1-1 12:00:00 14 Apr 25
SILENT KNIGHT by Honeywell	04/14/2025 12:00 Panel 32 Event: Manual Pull Alarm Zone 001 [M01:P0001] CONFERENCE ROOM
Advanced	ALARM 12:00:00 1:001.0 Zone 0001 04/14/25 SWITCH(MON.) CONFERENCE ROOM Pull Station
EDWARDS	ALARM ACTIVE :: 07:20:19 09/24/2018 P:01 C:01 D:0001 SMOKE DETECTOR CONFERENCE ROOM
POTTER The Symbol of Protection	<event> ... <state>Alarm</state> ... <ptname>CONFERENCE ROOM</ptname> <ptid>009</ptid> <pttype>SMOKE DETECTOR</pttype> ... </event>

Appendix C — References

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REFERENCE NOTE Verify project requirements against the adopted NFPA 72 edition, the AHJ, and authoritative manufacturer documentation. Other cited materials support architectural and historical comparisons in this paper.

Related publications and discussion

SAFER Protocol v1.1, the Common Vocabulary, related publications, and opportunities for implementation feedback are available at:

https://github.com/rescuelogic/SAFER

This review paper offers technical discussion and explanatory examples. It does not amend SAFER Protocol v1.1 or establish new conformance requirements.